

OnePlus 15R

Strengths that make up for shortcomings

If you have been following OnePlus' journey as I have, it's hard to miss that the

R-series has always carried an unusual responsibility within the brand's lineup. This is the space where the brand has always tried to balance performance, usability and long-term reliability without drifting afar in any one direction. The OnePlus 15R continues in that vein.

At a starting price of Rs 47,999 for the 12GB RAM and 256GB storage model, rising all the way up to Rs 52,999 for the 512GB storage option, the OnePlus 15R finds itself in a segment with strong performers and where potential buyers are no longer forgiving of half-baked measures.

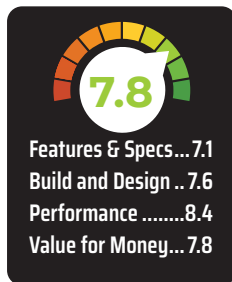
DESIGN AND BUILD

If you've seen or used a recent OnePlus R-series phone, the 15R will feel familiar the moment you pick it up. It's got flat sides, a clean glass back, a camera module that sits quietly in the corner and symmetry that OnePlus has been refining for a few generations now.

The build quality is solid. You get an aluminium frame that feels rigid and the buttons have a crisp, confident click. This is the kind of phone you stop thinking about after a day or two because it doesn't have a learning curve attached. It feels secure in hand even if you despise slapping a case on your phone as the flat edges help the ergonomics and the back panel resists fingerprints instead of turning it into a smudge magnet.

I've been using the Mint Breeze colourway which is soft, light and more

₹52,999



conservative than say the Electric Violet variant which has a subtle texture running through the middle. The green colour has an almost hazy and muted texture that doesn't quite catch your eye but it also doesn't completely disappear visually when it's lying face down on a desk.

The camera module is neatly integrated, raised just enough to house the two cameras and because of that, the phone doesn't rock annoyingly on a table. At 218 grams, the weight distribution stays even, be it extended gaming sessions or camera use and it never feels top-heavy or tiring in the hand.

The 15R covers splashes and harsher conditions with IP68 and IP69K water and dust protection that makes the phone easier to live with.

Size-wise, the 15R plays to the middle of the market but if you are attached to

compact phones like the OnePlus 13s, this won't convert you. For everyone else, it settles into daily use easily.

PERFORMANCE

The OnePlus 15R is powered by the Qualcomm Snapdragon 8 Gen 5 SoC paired with 12GB LPDDR5X RAM and upto 512GB UFS 4.1 storage options.

That combination alone is the most consequential upgrade over the 13R and it does more than inflate benchmark scores. In my extended use, it became clear that this is a phone tuned for sustained performance rather than short power bursts.

In synthetic benchmarks, it performs as you'd expect from a performance-focused flagship.

The 15R scores 2,892,035 in AnTuTu, 2,886 in Geekbench single-core, and 9,535 in the multi-core test. The PCMark Work test returns a score of 14,315, indicating strong productivity performance, while 3DMark Wild Life Extreme lands at 5,320.

Now, these are solid results, but a more telling figure comes from the CPU throttling test, where the 15R sustains around 92% of its peak performance on average in multiple runs which explains a lot about how the phone feels during longer sessions.

In daily use, the 15R offers extremely zen-like stability. Apps open instantly, switching between heavy workloads is effortless and OxygenOS 16 doesn't pull back on performance to maintain thermal threshold.

Gaming performance is quite exceptional due to this tuning. In BGMI, the phone averaged around 159 FPS over a 30-minute session, with peak temperatures hovering at approximately 40.9 degrees Celsius, which is a bit warm but not uncomfortably so. Genshin Impact maintained a steady 120 FPS average while staying under 40 degrees. More importantly, there were no sudden drops in frame rates even during longer combat-heavy sections or touch response and the experience remained